

Interviewer: Recording it over the cloud. And we are recording now. So just for the record, [Speaker], I'd like to ask your permission again on record that you are allowing me-

Speaker: Yes po.

Interviewer: To record the interview.

Speaker: Yes po.

Interviewer: All right. Thank you. Thank you for that. So I think, as mentioned in my email to you, I told you that this is a study. It's a study that's being done over in five countries. And it's generally about relationship quality and relationship satisfaction. And that's really all it is. So I'm going to be asking you a lot of questions about the relationship that you're in right now and how satisfied you are with your relationship?

Interviewer: And how you assess the quality of your relationship because that's what we want to find out, how people assess the quality of their relationships. So first of all, some demographics. How old are you now?

Speaker: I am currently [21-25] years old.

Interviewer: [21-25]. And it's okay that I call you [Speaker]. Is that your nickname?

Speaker: Yes, po.

Interviewer: All right. Oh, I forgot to introduce myself. I'm [Interviewer]. I teach at the psychology department of [University]. And I'm part of this project, collecting data for the team. Are you still in college?

Speaker: Yes po. I am a [undergraduate] in [University 1].

Speaker: So this is my [1st-5th] degree, actually. But it's an undergraduate degree.

Interviewer: Oh, but it's an undergraduate degree.

Speaker: Yes po.

Interviewer: Yeah. What's your major, if I may ask?

Speaker: So my first major, my first degree was [program]. So I graduated from [University 2] earlier this year. And this year, I'm completing my [degree program]. So yes.

Interviewer: Wow, that's very interesting. It's connected to your first degree and it's very modern.

Speaker: Opo.

Interviewer: It's very very timely and relevant. You're about to have a very fruitful career, I think.

Speaker: Hopefully.

Interviewer: All right. So thank you. You're [20-25]. You're earning your second degree. And as far as your relationship is concerned, how long have you been in this current relationship?

Speaker: So we've been together since [Month] [Year]. So that's [several] years now, [several] years.

Interviewer: Wow. Okay. That's quite a long time. Would you say that's a long time for a relationship?

Speaker: Yeah, I think that's a pretty long time.

Interviewer: Yeah, it does sound pretty long then. You're very young, but I will have to ask if you've any children?

Speaker: No.

Interviewer: And in your household, your dorm in [City 1]. Do you have roommates in [City 1]?

Speaker: Yes, I used to have [1-2] roommates, but since one of them graduated and the other one moved out to move in with her sister, so I only have [1-2] roommate.

Interviewer: So one roommate. How long do you stay in [City 1] every week, like Monday to Friday?

Speaker: Generally, I stay as long as I want to and I just visit home like every other week or so or.

Interviewer: Every other week.

Speaker: Or every month.

Interviewer: And this is in [Province 1]?

Speaker: Yes po.

Interviewer: And who lives in [Province 1] with you?

Speaker: So I have my mom, my dad, and my sibling.

Interviewer: Oh, okay. How many siblings do you have?

Speaker: Just [1-5].

Interviewer: Just [1-5]. And are you the older sibling or the younger one?

Speaker: I'm the eldest, yes.

Interviewer: You're the older one. All right. So it's your mom. Okay. It's no help and nobody else aside from mom, dad, and your sibling.

Speaker: No help.

Interviewer: All right. Okay. Well, you're a [occupation]. Am I to assume that you're not yet working? You don't have any source of income, your own income right now?

Speaker: Yes, none.

Interviewer: Okay. [Occupation], yes.

Speaker: Yes po.

Interviewer: And you said [Partner]. Is that his nickname, [Partner]?

Speaker: Yes, [Partner].

Interviewer: Okay. And how do I say that? You introduce him to people as your boyfriend. That's what you call him, boyfriend, right?

Speaker: Yes, usually boyfriend, jowa, partner.

Interviewer: Oh, okay.

Speaker: Whatever the situation.

Interviewer: Oh, and is that how he introduces you as well?

Speaker: Yes, yes.

Interviewer: Jowa, girlfriend.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Okay. So let's talk about how that started with your jowa, right? When did you meet [1-5] years ago? How did you meet?

Speaker: Okay. So we're in the same high school.

Speaker: Because we technically met in [grade school], but it wasn't like a meet me. It was just we know of each other in [grade school] because we were in different sections. So I guess we officially met in [grade school] when we actually were in the same section in school. So what happened was I have this friend and she kind of like befriended like two other people and one of them was [Partner].

Speaker: And we kind of like formed a small group of friends. I mean, I had other friends also, but you know, with the whole shuffling sections, it's kind of inevitable that we make new friends. So yeah, so there was that [1-5] of us and one of them was [Partner]. And like over time, I guess we weren't that close at first? I was closer to the other two. But over time, we asked each other about like requirements and other stuff like that. And I kind of developed feelings. I was very much in denial.

Speaker: So for the first like [1-5] years in high school, I did not have very great experiences romantically speaking. So I'm in an interview.

Interviewer: Say again?

Speaker: Sorry about that.

Speaker: Yeah, where was I? Yeah, so I developed feelings. I was in denial about it until like I kind of couldn't keep it in anywhere. And I told my friends and it's just there was a lot of pining. That's the term that we like to use. Like I was a close friend to him. But that's all it ever was. But eventually, like we got closer and closer. And like the entire time, I pretty much just had feelings the whole time until this there was a month in [Month] that it kind of just like escalated a lot. And we didn't want to say anything yet, even though we were both feeling something already. And like Christmas break passed over of us just like tiptoeing the whole thing until we like agree that we talk once we get back to school in [Month]. So we did. And I confessed to him with an original song, which I'm very proud of.

Interviewer: Wow, you wrote a song?

Speaker: Yeah, I wrote the song first. So I was I was actually very proud of that. And yeah, and it was actually kind of funny then because after I confessed with the song, he was just like rambling and explaining other stuff. He didn't say that he reciprocated yet.

Interviewer: Oh, wow.

Speaker: So it was just like, like at the end of his rambling, he was like, so same.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: What year was that? What year was that? That was [Year].

Speaker: [Year]. So we'd have to be like grade. And how old were we? We met in [grade school]. What was such a long time ago? It might have been [grade school] or probably [grade school].

Interviewer: So you were in the same section when you were in [grade school] and it took about [1-5] year for you to write that song for him.

Speaker: Yeah. Yes.

Interviewer: About a year. Yeah.

Speaker: Actually, I have the statistics. I tell myself like I've been finding for him for [6-10] months.

Interviewer: Oh, wow. Yeah. Was it love at first sight?

Speaker: It wasn't. So like we formed a friend group, right?

Speaker: We weren't that close. It was just so yeah. So this person is part of the group work. We're sort of friends, but more of acquaintances.

Speaker: And then we just developed from there until I realized, oh no.

Interviewer: Yeah, then you started having feelings. Yeah. And then when you wrote that song and when you sang that song to him, did you have any idea at all whether or not he liked you back?

Speaker: I did. Like I had a suspicion because like that month in [Month].

Speaker: Like things sort of escalated with us hanging out all the time.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: Especially since like usually at that time in during finals week, we get half days in class. So obviously the rest of the days meant for reviewing, but we don't do that.

Speaker: So we like go have movies, go eat with other friends but most of the time we just were like kind of stuck to each other.

Speaker: So there were already like brewing stuff from there and our friends also noticed that.

Interviewer: All right. So that's how it started. And now [5-10] years into the future, when you think about, okay, I've been here in this relationship for the past [5-10] years and I don't know how often you

think about it or I don't think people get asked often, but although siguro as much only in as much as people say, okay, how are you? how's the relationship? If I like now I'm asking you, how would you assess the quality? That's the meat of our, that's the million dollar question I have for you for the interview diba. But how would, well, siguro, my first question is how would the quality of your relationship, how do you think it compares to other people's like your friends or your people in your family? How is your relationship quality compared to other people's relationship quality? Do you think it's average? It's the same as the others? Or do you think it's of higher quality than most other people or less in quality than most other people?

Speaker: Okay. So for me, I feel like it's higher in quality.

Speaker: My parents, oh, I hope they can hear me, but their relationship is kind of turbulent. There were a lot of struggles that happened in the past, probably [10-15] years now. So they get along okay, but there are times when the arguments kind of blow up. So I wouldn't say that they, I'm not even sure if they actually like spending time with each other anymore.

Speaker: So that's like one side of it. In terms of my friends, I think they're doing pretty well. Mostly probably, you know, the whole birds of the same feather flock together. So in my high school friend group, a lot of us are paired up together then as partners since high school as well. So I think they're doing pretty well. One of them is like more on the chill side. Like they spend time with each other. They're cool, but they're not super outward with the displays of affection. But it's there.

Speaker: So I mean, I wouldn't know the specifics of their relationships. So I think their quality is also pretty good. And the other couple in our friend group is also right. They've had a rough spot in freshman year when one of them wasn't able to like spend a lot of time with the other person. And the other person tried to talk about it. And it's like, yeah, and it wasn't going well, but they resolved that thankfully.

Interviewer: So they're okay now?

Speaker: So right now they're also okay. But the reason that I'd say mine is of a higher quality, probably because of my experiences as well. And like, you know, throughout my life personally, especially the when I mentioned the first [1-5] years of high school, there's like a lot of there's a lot of how do I describe this like games in a sense that it's it's not how do I like a lot of mind games. Yeah, that's a term mind games. And you know, it's very tiring to deal with those types of things. It's never, I never had an official relationship outside of this one I have with [Partner]. But I did have like, situationships, I think that's what they call it these days,

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: What we used to call like MU, or stuff like that. Yeah, I didn't actually even reach the point of MU, because it was like a lot of tiptoeing around each other. But like, there's something there. And I don't know, they were very mentally emotionally tackling events. I joke a lot that I could write young adult novels, a trilogy with my first [1-5] years. That's how hectic it was. So yeah, [Partner] is an insane upgrade from those first [1-5] years that I'm actually, I was convinced for a time that I'd only like I'd only get like a year of any sort of like romantic intimacy with anyone. So being with [Partner] actually confessing to him was sort of a leap of faith for me in a sense that I would I hope that it would last

longer than a year. But I wasn't really betting on it, because I felt like I was cursed not to be with someone romantically for more than that. So [1-5] years is, wow, insane.

Interviewer: Wow, great.

Speaker: But yes, I think what really helped was in terms of like why I consider it like of higher quality is because we talk to each other. I really like that there's no mind games at all. It's very clear what we want to do, how we want to spend time with each other, and all of that. So when we have like, maybe conflicting feelings, or if we have like conflicts, contradictions going on, we talk about it, we don't let it simmer for longer. So yeah, yeah, that's pretty much like the gist of it.

Interviewer: So just to make sure I understood, you believe that your relationship quality is higher than most other people. One, because you have, you think you have less arguments than other people, definitely less than your parents. And like one of the couples in your friend group, you said they had that big, how do I call it, conflict?

Interviewer: Yeah, some kind of big conflict long ago. And you didn't have anything like that with your relationship, right? Is that what you're saying?

Speaker: I wouldn't say nothing.

Speaker: But to the scale that it was like, well, there was like one, but that was like very early into the relationship. And my mental stability was not great.

Speaker: I guess I had like issues and I had a lot of insecurities. I had issues with that. And I didn't feel like I deserve to be in a relationship. So like that was, that was more of an internal thing. It wasn't an actual like argument with [Partner] himself. It was more of an internal struggle with myself and feeling like I shouldn't be in a relationship.

Speaker: But that was probably like the most, the closest we ever got to ever breaking up because I was having like internal issues.

Interviewer: Right. And it wasn't anything that he did. It was more something inside you.

Speaker: Yeah, yes. Yes.

Interviewer: That's interesting. I'll ask a little more about that, how that unfolded in the relationship and how you almost broke up, you say at that time. So I'm going to go back to that later.

Interviewer: But for now, you said that, you know, one of the sources of that struggle was you believing that you're not, you don't deserve, is that the word that you use? That you're not, you don't deserve to be in a relationship? You're not supposed to be in a relationship?

Interviewer: And that you had, you did say you had previous relationships, but there were mind games in those relationships and all that. And it wasn't as satisfying as your current relationship. How many, how many have past relationships did you have before, before [Partner]?

Speaker: I guess they weren't, like I said, they weren't really official relationships. They were like tiptoeing around the line of situationship, but never actually reaching that point. So probably, let me count. There was [1-5], around [1-5].

Interviewer: Around [1-5] that you would consider to be past romantic relationships?

Speaker: Not necessarily.

Interviewer: Right. Not official.

Speaker: Not official. Just a romantic fling or something.

Speaker: I'm not sure what term I should use. I guess it was a friendship, if we consider a friendship's relationships also.

Interviewer: But does it differ, those friendships, do they differ from regular friendships in terms of a romantic component?

Speaker: Yes yes.

Interviewer: So there's a romantic component. And those relationships weren't really very satisfying. There weren't really what you would consider quality relationships. One, because aside from, one is they're short-lived and you believe they're short-lived because there were a lot of mind games happening in those relationships. Right? What do you mean by that? Mind games? It's like, what does that mean?

Speaker: It's been so long. Mind games, sometimes I wanted to label it or make it official, but well, at least for one of them. So one of them, I wanted to actually make it official, but I don't think that he felt the same. So there were a lot of, he wanted to have me around, but didn't want it to be an actual relationship thing. So that was probably one of them. The other one was very manipulative in a sense. He actually liked me first and made advances. And I was like, okay, we can be friends. But it got manipulative in a sense that he'd emotionally guilt me into sticking around, into supporting him or staying with him, being staying and continuing to be friends with him in a sense that he'd degrade himself, self-degradation. Was that the term? Self-deprecation, sorry. It's been so long.

Interviewer: Self-deprecation.

Speaker: And he'd rant to me. He'd basically, all those types of things, like, oh, I'm such a bad person. I shouldn't be here. To the point of sometimes those sensitive topics of suicidal ideation and other things like that. It was very emotionally taxing. And, you know, that wasn't really like someone I wanted to have around exactly. But I was like, you know, guilted into staying. So that one, that guy actually had friends also that he emotionally manipulated. So not just romantically.

Speaker: And they all like cut him off in the end. So yeah, that was the thing. That was the whole other thing. With the last two, they were actually like in the same quote-unquote era. They're in the same year and we ended up actually being friends, like the [1-5] of us. So what happened there was with the shuffling of sections, my main friend grew, I got separated from him. So we were [1-5]. There were three sections, two of them in one section, two of them in the other. And I was left in the last section alone. So I had to make new friends. And I ended up befriending these two people. And we hit it off, we became like the [1-5] of us friends. And what happened was, this is so cliché, but what happened was I had like a crush on one of them. And the other one had a crush on me. But the one I had my crush, at the time, didn't feel the same. And I didn't feel the same towards the person who had a crush on me. So, you know, but what happened was sort of like that went on because we were friends. And I know that I

also had like faults in that specific era there. Because obviously I was a kid, I really didn't know a lot of things. And I also had like mental issues going on. So I wasn't the best of friends either. So I wasn't like that great to them. So it was just kind of a mess. And the people around us also caught wind of what's going on and nakisawsaw din sila. And I don't know, it ended up being like in the end, it ended up being like sort of like I'm leading both of them on for some reason.

Speaker: And I'm supposed to quote and quote, choose already. And all that. But the problem was I wanted to keep them both as friends. But I felt like if I chose someone, then I'd ended up losing the other as a friend. So it was terrible.

Interviewer: And how did it end?

Speaker: So how that ended actually, pretty sad note, I ended up quote and quote, choosing someone because like everyone around me was kind of like forcing me to do so. And so, but I chose like my crush. But that crush of mine, while he reciprocated like some feelings, like that was actually so annoying. Because there was like a point where I was explaining to people that I just wanted to be friends with him. But at that point in our friendship, like we sort of had maybe some intimate moment, not like romantically intimate moments, but like, you know, like vulnerable intimate type of moments. And I don't know, I guess he got angry because he overheard it. And then he said, I thought we were something more. And I was like, I thought you didn't have feelings for me. What is going on?

Speaker: So that was something. And then I also developed feelings for the person who had a crush on me.

Speaker: So that was weird overall, like I had feelings for both of them. And I didn't.

Interviewer: This was all before [grade school]. So that was like doing your high school. Right. Right.

Speaker: Yes. A great night. So that was a wild year.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: So how it ended was I chose the person who had a crush on me. And like me, summer went by and summer was going on. And we're in a high school where we kind of have students coming from all around [region]. So we were kind of long distance during that summer. And all we had was chat. So what happens is he has a tendency to like close himself off, he called it his like hermit mode. So he would like close himself off from the world basically and like just stick to like a couple of friends, like really close friends. And I wasn't quite of that. So I got really frustrated because I tried to like connect with him and it wasn't like working out. And like in the end, by the next year, he didn't realize what he did. And he just like figured that I was angry.

Interviewer: Oh, wow.

Speaker: Again, there was no talking going on there. Zero talking.

Interviewer: So that's what you meant. That's what you meant when you said mind games.

Interviewer: A lot of lack of open communication, I would say. No, you didn't talk about a lot of like they depended on you or you depended on them and you they depended on you just catching on to how they're feeling and nobody really talked about it out loud. I can't help but ask, do you think age was a

factor? Because you were so young in those relationships, you're much older, although you weren't much older when you met [Partner], but you're much older now. But do you think age played a factor in why those relationships didn't work or it was really the dynamic between the two of you or it was really the partner's personality? Like what do you attribute the low quality of their relationship? Sabi mo games. Is it because now you're dealing with two young people in those relationships or it's just the kind of person that you were with? Even if you met them now, if that's their personality, the relationship would still play out the same way?

Speaker: I think age was certainly a part of it. I don't know to what extent but like yeah, I think part of it was we didn't know like how to like do these types of things. If that makes sense because I feel like another part of it is also like how we grow up or what we learn from our environment and I guess like specifically for me, talking is either silent treatments or like blown up arguments. So I guess I also didn't like, I didn't like those blown up arguments so I kind of just got non-confrontational and stuck to the silent treatment type of stuff and guilt tripping.

Interviewer: Right. These days, I mean in this present relationship, you don't resort to those, why don't you resort to those things anymore? I mean I'm assuming you don't. Am I assuming correctly?

Speaker: I'd like to believe that I don't think so.

Interviewer: Why do you think so? Why don't you rely on those tactics anymore?

Speaker: I guess like over time, I realized that it doesn't do anything. It doesn't fix anything. It doesn't address the the root of the situation. It doesn't address the issue. So it also made me feel very bad. It felt awful. So like sometimes I still have like an urge to do that. I would admit that I still sometimes be like, oh I don't want to talk to you right now. I'm super angry. But instead of ignoring the messages, I tell them exactly. I don't feel great. Like I feel pretty angry. I'll come back to you later when I feel calm. So yeah.

Interviewer: That works better for you.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Oh, very good. Very nice. Yeah. You seem to touch a lot on open communication though. When you say now our relationship works because there's open communication. There's meaning no mind games. You don't have to read each other's minds and be open with how you're feeling. If something upsets you, tell the other person. What else? Obviously you think that's what makes for good quality relationship. Are there any other things that you think makes for good quality relationships aside from open communication like that?

Speaker: So hard. Because I feel like for me that's the foundation of it already. Because okay, so I guess maybe if I branch out from it a little, it's important to be on the same page in a sense that sometimes you just won't agree on something at all. Like I guess basic example like having kids, I guess.

Speaker: So if someone like wants to have kids and the other one doesn't, then I don't think that relationship will ever work out no matter what they do. Because it's like a fundamental like wish that someone has that the other one doesn't want to have for themselves. They're both valid. But they can't have that with each other. So what I'm trying to say is it's important to be on the same page with like big

decisions, big things in life that you want to have for your future if you want to have that future with each other. So yes.

Interviewer: Good example. It's fundamental. It's basic. It's like a deal breaker if you can't agree on a certain thing. And one of them is, in the future will you have kids? Is that something that you and [Partner] ever talked about already? Or is that just a random example?

Speaker: We've like touched on it. We don't really want to talk too deep into it. But we have like whenever we like touched it, we're like, yeah, we both agree like we don't want to.

Interviewer: Oh, how interesting. Yeah. Is there what other fundamental things are in the same category as that? Like whether or not you're having kids, I hope, I suppose like whether or not you want to migrate something like that, right? Something big like that where you can't write any other thing where you want to live, whether or not you're having kids. What else can you give me some more examples of those that you and [Partner] are on the same page on? Is there something that big?

Speaker: None that comes to mind right now. There probably might be, but like right now, I don't think so.

Interviewer: But you feel like in all of your conversations, you're on the same page on the important things. Yes, pretty much. Yeah. Although you can't recall right now. Another example of an important thing like that and other relationships you think are not good quality because they don't agree on those important things. Deal breaker, certain disagreements are a deal breaker for relationships. Yeah. And you have not encountered any such thing in this relationship yet. Yeah. That's why you're here for five years. Right. Okay. So that's a very good example actually. It's very clear. It's black and white whether or not you can stay together or whether or not you can be happy together if you're not agreeing on something so important. And again, it's connected to another and it's also connected to being open. Sometimes people don't talk about it and they didn't realize that or they skirt around the issue and try to avoid it because they know it's going to be a source of conflict. Any other thing that you think like when you advise people or when other people are wondering whether or not they're going to get into a relationship with one person or the other person? What any other example that you can think of that, oh, if you're going to get into a relationship and you want it to be a good relationship, it has to be what? What comes to mind?

Speaker: I think it's also important to, well, I guess this is a corollary to everything else, but it's important to know yourself because if you're not sure what you want, you're not going to know what you want for the future, then you won't know if you do want to, if this person is compatible with, if you're compatible with it, but with what this person wants as well. So yeah, I think also even with like the personality type of things, like if you don't know how you live, I guess your lifestyle.

Interviewer: You're talking about your own. Yeah, okay.

Speaker: I guess if you don't know those types of things about yourself, then it's very hard to deal with someone because it's like you're not fully there yet. I guess the sense is like you're not ready to be in a relationship yet. For example, I guess for me personally, like in that first year of our relationship, the thing I mentioned that almost maybe break up with him.

Speaker: Because I had like a lot of internal struggles, a lot of insecurities, and I think those are like the types of things that I needed to have resolved before being in a relationship because I wasn't sure of myself. And so that kind of like really seeped into everything else in my life. So yeah, I think it's really important to just generally be secure before like getting into anything. Yeah.

Interviewer: That's interesting because that's a factor that's very internal. It has nothing to do with the two-person dynamic. It has to be that you're fully self-aware and you know yourself and you've grown enough, you've matured enough to be ready to be in any relationship at all. Because if you don't, what you're saying is if you're not ready personally, no matter how good the partner is or no matter how good the circumstances are, if you yourself are not whole and mature, it's not going to work. It's not going to be a good relationship is what you're saying.

Interviewer: That's very interesting. Yeah, it says a lot about your past relationships and you think maybe that's why they weren't high quality or they weren't good quality because you were not at that stage yet. Yeah. And I shouldn't say even at the beginning of this current relationship, you were not really totally there yet. That's why you had that big conflict.

Interviewer: Yeah, very interesting. Very, very insightful if I may say. Thank you. Okay, very nice. Yeah, let's see. So if I may summarize, you said what is important in a relationship is one, the person himself or herself is ready. Singularly, like individually, the two people getting into a relationship must be ready for a relationship and they must be able to communicate with each other and they must be on the same page on important things like it's okay to not be on the same page on less important things like where you're going to eat or stuff like that or what movie you're going to see. But on the important things you have to be on the same page as the other person. Yeah. Okay, now a very slum book question. Slum book.

Interviewer: What is love for you because people say, okay, relationship, if it's romantic, then love has to play a part in it. Do you agree? Love has to be a component of a quality romantic relationship.

Speaker: I'd like to say yes, but it depends on your definition of love.

Interviewer: Very good. And what is yours? What is yours?

Speaker: So actually, like, I had an idea for the longest time, I had an idea of what it was for me, but it was in my lesson in [Subject]. It was vocation and marriage, funnily enough, that we got this lesson from [Author]. I don't agree with [Author] himself, but what his lessons on love is actually a really good definition of what love is. So I'm actually going to look for it in my notes right now.

Interviewer: Sure. Yeah.

Speaker: What year was it? Trying to find it.

Interviewer: [Author] definition, and you don't agree with that definition?

Speaker: No, no, no, I agree. I agree with this definition. I don't agree with the person.

Interviewer: Okay, okay. Oh, okay, okay, okay. But you like his definition of love.

Speaker: Yes, I like his definition. So there were five that I was able to summarize here.

Speaker: So first is love must have a goal or purpose. So this is like a spiritual, like the purpose is meant to be quote unquote spiritual growth. So to me, this means like developing as a person striving to be the best person one can be. So the goal of love is to strive to be the best person that you can be. And two is love is a circular process. So growing doesn't end. Growing is infinite. There's no, there's never actually going to be a best version. You're just going to keep striving to be better every time. So this is like extending your limits, being more like you always continue to be more than you are now. So this love, I think this doesn't just encompass romantic love. This is just love in general for me. And I really like it because it takes all forms of love.

Speaker: So number three, love for others includes self love. So I like to think of it this way, like, you can't really take care of others, you can't love others if you're not taking care of yourself. So if you want to love others to the best of your abilities, you have to love yourself as well so that you can love them. So you're more able to give love the more that you're able to do so yourself. So yeah, number four is love is not effortless. So to extend yourself to keep being more, to surpass your limits, to go beyond. Love is done through demonstration. So we're exerting a constant effort to keep loving, to keep being more, to keep, yeah, like that. And the last one is love is an act of will. So for [Author], he uses the word will, it means it's a deliberate decision. So this distinguishes it from the concepts of like desire and action.

Speaker: So will is like a desire of sufficient intensity that it is translated into action. So you may want to be loving, but it's different to actually be loving. So when we choose to love, it's not something we're forced to do. We love because we choose to contribute to our own or someone else's growth. So the goal is growth. So yeah, that's my definition of that.

Interviewer: An interesting point that you mentioned where love is not the same as desire, it's an act of will. Because love is an act of will, desire is not. Are you talking about like attraction, for example? That's not, you didn't willing will yourself to be attracted to someone, it's just there. You didn't will yourself to desire someone, it just happened. And that's not what love is. Tama ba, is that what you're saying?

Interviewer: That's not love yet, yeah? When you meet someone and you feel attraction towards them and you like you want them in your life, you're saying that's not love yet.

Speaker: Not yet, no.

Interviewer: Oh, so when does it become love then?

Speaker: It becomes love when you actually strive to be with that person, strive to, well not necessarily be with that person, but strive to want to see that person grow, want to strive to contribute to that person's growth.

Speaker: So it's the action that's the will, the translating it into action. One thing to translate it into action is the yes.

Interviewer: Okay, and you did mention that in one of the definitions of pek, one is you have demonstrations of love, actual observable actions of love.

Interviewer: And what qualifies as that a demonstration, like when you give somebody flowers or when you buy them gifts or when you text them good night, good morning?

Interviewer: What qualifies as a demonstration of love and not just desire, for example?

Speaker: Okay, so this five love languages thing that's going around is pretty, I don't know, I'm pretty sure it's a pseudoscience,

Speaker: but it's also, I'm pretty sure it's a pseudoscience, but also it's a nice way to be able to quantify what sorts of love that you like to give, that you like to receive. It doesn't have to be just one of them, it can be one more or all of them. So for me specifically, minus quality time, so I like to spend time with the people I love, whether it's just in parallel play or actually doing something together, that's the biggest one for me. So whether romantic or otherwise, it's always been quality time for me. Another one is physical touch. So for romantic relationships, this one specifically, physical touch.

Speaker: So I don't know if I was deprived of this in my childhood, I don't think I was. But it's just, it's just like really warm and cozy for me to be able to like hug someone, kiss someone, and all of that. So I don't know, for me, this is specific to our romantic relationships, because I feel like it's something that I want to just, like I want to serve for this special person, not that my friends aren't special people,

Speaker: but like I don't think, I wouldn't mind the man if my friends hug me. Hugging is fun. But yeah, it's not something that I normally like initiate with them. So yeah, I don't know, I just, I guess I just have the subconscious of wanting to reserve it for that special someone. And yeah, I also like to give gifts, not necessarily receive them funny, funnily enough. I guess I'm okay with receiving, but like it's not, I'm not sure if I appreciate it so much, especially since I'm kind of picking with my gifts.

Speaker: In a sense, I feel bad because if it's a gift that I won't be able to use, that I won't be able to like fully appreciate, but I like to give gifts.

Speaker: I like to, because for me, I want to, like it doesn't have to be something that you spend on, it doesn't have to be monetary. And like just something that you put your time and effort into, like a card, like a little note, it's stuff like that.

Speaker: Yeah, so those kinds of things, I like to give a lot because it's so nice to love.

Interviewer: Right right. So yeah, go ahead.

Speaker: So those are my main three.

Interviewer: So the way you, the way you conceptualize love in your life, I, that kind of love must be present in a relationship. That's what you're saying.

Interviewer: That kind of love must be present in a relationship. And if it's not, then what do you think about relationships?

Speaker: I'd feel like if I didn't, like if I wasn't able to do those kinds of love or like receive those kinds of love, I'd feel like, for example, I'm not really an active service type of person. It's, I appreciate it very much, but it's like not something that I feel like I fully appreciate. So yeah, like I feel like maybe there's something missing, especially quality time, especially for me.

Speaker: If I don't get a lot of quality time, I just feel like I'm growing distant from, growing distant from people. So yeah, it's really important, especially the pandemic was so hard.

Interviewer: Yeah. So you think when you don't receive that, like quality time, for example, and you don't get that in a relationship, then would you say that's a problem?

Speaker: Yes, I wouldn't feel fulfilled. Like it wouldn't be like a place that I'd be content to be in. So yeah.

Interviewer: So right now, do you experience love in this relationship?

Speaker: Very much.

Interviewer: Yeah, very much. Yeah. And you said love comes from inside of you. Love starts with a person before it, before you expect it from other people. But when it comes to reciprocated love, like you feel all these things, you want growth, you want to keep changing for the better, you want to do all these demonstrations yourself. How about your partner? Do you feel love coming from his direction to you?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Yes, you do?

Speaker: Yes, I do. He's very supportive of me. He's actually so patient. I don't understand how we went through that first year.

Speaker: Because like I mentioned, I had all these insecurities, all these internal struggles within myself. I was really convinced that I should break up with him. Because otherwise, like I just kind of like blow up, be destructive for both of us. But he really held on. He was so patient with me. He was like, I'll just be here. I'm going to stick around. Okay. And like, I feel that was so important for the both of us that we wanted to, you know, stay together despite that.

Speaker: And I think that really spurred me on to want to become better for him.

Speaker: So that I would deserve this kind of patience, this kind of love that he's given me. So throughout our years, he's really patient with me.

Speaker: He supports me, especially in my studies sometimes. Because we have like [Subjects] in [Redacted] core in [University 1]. So he's very competent in those types of topics.

Speaker: So like I asked like a bunch of questions from him also. And he'd like actually generally help me out and like go so deep comprehensive into it. I'd say he's the reason I got like a bunch of A's and some of my subjects.

Speaker: So yeah. So I just really appreciate that all this time he spent with me and keeping one thing to spend time with me, even though sometimes I know that I can be a little difficult to deal with.

Interviewer: So in what way do you think you're difficult?

Speaker: Sometimes I'm not able to properly emotionally regulate myself.

Speaker: So sometimes I'd be a little like pikon or whatever. And like I wouldn't be able to tell him, I'm feeling a little annoyed right now or something. And I don't know, he just like, I guess he just he understands that this is something that like I kind of do once in a while, but it never means anything. So yeah. He's patient.

Interviewer: When you're like that, you say he's patient. What makes you say that now? Ah, he's patient. Why? What does he do?

Speaker: I guess he's going to be like, what can I do for you? How are you feeling?

Speaker: And all those types of things. And he'd actually like try to like make me feel better. Because he knows that like any of my frustrations are anger. It's not really directed at him, unless I tell him and then we talk about it. But yeah, those kinds of things. And he'd tell me, what can I do to make you feel better? Is there anything? I don't know. And then we, yeah, like we actually go through the process. And like if there's something specific that I want, he'd do his best to get that done. So yeah.

Interviewer: So that one, the big conflict that you mentioned in your [1st-5th] year where you almost broke up and he was very patient with you, can you tell me a little bit more? How did that? You said it was something inside of you. What was it? What started it?

Speaker: Wow, it's been a long time. I barely remember what was actually going on in my mind.

Interviewer: But to the best of your memory, what started it? Yeah.

Speaker: The gist of it is that I just didn't feel enough. I didn't feel like, wait, you know what? I can look through my, because I have a diary. So I put all of my, like I have some thoughts here.

Speaker: And I'm sure I have it somewhere here. [Year], [Year], I have to find [Year].

Interviewer: But you said it's something, it's not something, it's not, it wasn't because of something he did, right?

Speaker: No, it wasn't something he did. It was more of like, am I good enough? Is he going to get bored with me?

Speaker: I guess like part of it also because like I had that one year curse thing, right? Like I only have like a relationship for a year.

Speaker: And I guess after that, I felt like I was the problem. So wow. And it wasn't anything.

Interviewer: Yeah, it wasn't anything at all that happened. Nothing happened. He just suddenly started thinking, maybe this should end.

Speaker: Sort of like that. And I think a lot of it, okay, okay, I remember something. So a big part of it also is when he's away for a long time, there was this one time that he was at a conference abroad, and with other students, and I wasn't joining that. So I just, you know, with the whole quality time thing, I tend to be super clingy to a fault.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: I felt like he wasn't giving me attention, especially when I was having like my little mental sort of episodes, difficulties thing, and I needed someone to be there. And obviously, he's there and he has to like attend to his responsibilities, his life as well.

Speaker: And I can't expect him to like attend to me all the time.

Speaker: So I was like super upset about that. And then I got upset about being upset.

Interviewer: Right, right, that happens.

Speaker: Yeah, I was like, I don't deserve to be in a relationship if I can't figure myself out.

Interviewer: So that's when it happened. That was what led to that.

Speaker: Yeah, that was, I think it was the overseas conference. Yeah.

Interviewer: Right, right. I get it. So you're saying like, you're having a very negative reaction to something that you thought you shouldn't, you should not have been having a negative reaction to?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Right. Okay. So how did you, how did you resolve it then? How did, how did you decide, okay, I'm not gonna leave the relationship because of this? How did you decide that?

Speaker: If I remember correctly, like I actually like kept trying to convince him, you should, you should break up with me or like, I wasn't saying that I'm breaking up with you. I was saying, you should break up with me. I was telling him too. And like, at some point, like I just kept pushing it at some point, he was like, almost there, like agreeing. And like, we were about to go to bed like that. Like, like, yeah, I was about to sleep like that. And then he actually messaged again. And he was like, no, no, I can't accept this. This isn't happening.

Interviewer: And that's how it happened.

Speaker: Oh my God. I mean, part of me was very, I mean, part of me was relieved, of course, I didn't want to relieve, to leave the relationship. But like, I felt like I should. So I don't know, I guess I was like, okay, fine, we'll keep doing this. But if I ever like, have any more like, really bad reactions and stuff, I'd cut it. But like, yeah, it works out.

Interviewer: So it's like, it's like your disappointment in yourself, not with him, not with the relationship, your disappointment in yourself, that wow, that's very interesting. That was the biggest conflict you've had, you said, right?

Speaker: I believe that was, yeah.

Interviewer: Were there any smaller conflicts? Do you ever fight at all? After that first year?

Speaker: Smaller conflicts, we do sometimes, conflicts are normal.

Speaker: Not to the point of like, blowing up, obviously, that shouldn't be, I don't think, I don't think heated arguments are normal. I don't believe, I don't believe when people say, oh, shouting at each other is perfectly normal. That's just part of our relationship. It's not.

Speaker: You should be like, talking about these things properly in a calm manner, where you're both like, cooled off, and you can like, say your pieces properly.

Interviewer: So you don't have those, you don't have heated arguments and shouting and screaming?

Speaker: We just have like some small conflicts sometimes, and we'd explain like, I felt hurt, or I felt like this, because you did this. And so like, maybe next time we can do this instead. And yeah, like we just back and forth with basically that kind of template.

Interviewer: Like, what would be something that something he would do that would upset you and cost you to tell him, I don't like what you did, or you upset me when you did this? What can you give me an example of something like that?

Speaker: I guess one example is sometimes when I like to like plan things out like ahead. And I tend to ramble, I guess I tend to ramble and like start planning things out to the point that I'm actually trying to make it concrete. For example, like going out or going far, having going on a vacation trip or whatever. And I start like going into the logistics of everything. And what happens is we usually have these talks at the end of the day, we're both tired. And like, for me, I just like to, you know, think about these things. And I like to think about how we can make it happen already, as soon as possible. So so when I have this like thing that I want to do, I want to get it done. And I am so it's like the end of the day, and we're both tired. And sometimes [Partner] is very much more tired than me.

Speaker: And for well, I feel like kind of energized thinking about these things he doesn't. So so he gets tired, he gets like really dismissive about it. It sounds like he's not listening. And like, he's like, can like, he's not really into the conversation. So like, I get kind of upset when that happens. And I'll be like, and he wouldn't like say anything, because he's just he's just not there.

Speaker: And so what we did was I was like, I get upset when you do this, like, so can you just tell me when you're feeling tired and tell me when we can talk about it next instead? Or like, we can talk about it tomorrow or whatever, instead of just,

Interviewer: So you're willing, you're willing to postpone it, even if you're excited to talk about it.

Speaker: But if he's not into the topic, then okay, let's, let's, let's table it for now and talk about it when we're both read excited to talk about it. So that's okay with you.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: And what you don't like is that he doesn't tell you, but you can just sense his disinterest.

Speaker: Yes

Interviewer: Okay. And so, okay, so does that happen a lot? Since you already told him that no, I don't like it when you do that. Can you just tell me and we can just postpone it? Does it still happen?

Speaker: Not as much anymore, at least not recently. So yeah, I think I kind of sense it works.

Speaker: I myself would be like, do you want to talk about this some other time? Because I feel that he's not engaged in it anymore.

Interviewer: Right, so what about you? Is there something you ever do that upsets him that you know of?

Speaker: Let's see. You might get this out of him. I'm not sure.

Interviewer: Pero ikaw, as far as you know?

Speaker: Maybe when I get like, I like to think about, I like to like fantasize about the future. I like to like sort of not necessarily concrete na agad, but I like to think about what I'm going to like do, what I'm going to have and those types of things. And I think it tires him out, because it's like, I think he gets,

what do you call this? I feel like he gets tired thinking that it's like a final thing, like it's a non-negotiable already, or something like that. Or and like, to him, he doesn't really want to like set anything in stone, which is understandable. I mean, a lot of things can happen in the future.

Speaker: For me, I just like to stay dream about these sorts of things.

Interviewer: Oh, okay. And he doesn't like doing those.

Speaker: I guess he gets stressed out.

Interviewer: Right, right, right. Like, okay, but I'm thinking about being final already. Like you're set in stone. Oh, okay. So that's it. That's it. Things that upset you, things that start conflicts, they sound really small. Am I correct? Yeah, they're just eating the rest of them. Right. So you're very lucky. I guess that's why you think you have a high quality relationship compared to other people, because you don't really have those big fights, those big screaming matches that you see other people have.

Speaker: We don't. I'm so lucky to have him.

Interviewer: Right. Well, and you say it takes two, right? It takes two to make it work.

Interviewer: So you're lucky to have him, he's lucky to have you. You're lucky that you're ready and you're mature and you have that patience as well that you see in him. You seem to have that *siguro* as well for you to make this work. Okay, very interesting. One important thing to maintain a good relationship and yours specifically is quality time, which you are able to get all the time in this relationship. Any other things, aside from quality time, that to maintain a relationship, to avoid fighting, it's just as long as you can talk about it, be open with your feelings and don't scream.

Interviewer: And spend quality time with each other. And that's all you, for you, well, I won't say that's all because for some, that's really hard to achieve, but if you have that, then you maintain a good relationship is what you're saying.

Speaker: That's the foundation of it for me.

Interviewer: That's the foundation. Yeah. Okay. Very good. Very good. Now, then I would also think and assume that you think, you said in different words that this relationship is good for you. It makes you a better person and that's what love is. And that's what you do when you have love in the relationship. You keep growing and you keep changing into a better person. And do you believe you're still doing that five years into it?

Speaker: I guess not necessarily as like within the relationship dynamic anymore. I mean, we still have those little conflicts and we still talk about it. But I guess when it comes to the big things about development, it's still more of a more of a personal thing for both of us. So there are the things we want to do, things we want to improve on, career wise, skill wise, et cetera, et cetera, that we sort of just do. I'm not sure the word is separately, but like, kind of separately, but also we're supporting each other in a sense that we talk about these things with each other and we listen. And yeah, we just have these sort of discussions of what we want to do with our lives and all of those things.

Interviewer: So yeah. Right. Okay. So you were very different from the start when you were starting. Well, that was so long ago, especially for somebody [21-25], five years is such a long time ago. And you've changed. You believe you've changed.

Interviewer: Do you think your partner has changed also from who he was at the beginning to who he is now?

Speaker: I think he's changed in a sense that he's like a lot more understanding of me and like he knows me a lot more in a sense that he knows how to deal with me. So I don't think it's a very good connotation of the phrase, but yeah, something like that.

Interviewer: He's changed in that way. He's better at handling you.

Speaker: And I think also, I guess the person, he wasn't also very good at communicating his feelings and things like that.

Speaker: So that was something we learned together to be able to communicate better.

Interviewer: Right. Right. And you specifically, I want to hear from you. How about what changes did you want to go? How different are you aside from one is that you're more secure now? So people back then you weren't secure. And now as the relationship went on, you've grown to appreciate yourself and appreciate that yes, you deserve to be in a relationship. And yes, you can make a relationship work. Anything else other than that, any other change in you aside from that?

Speaker: It was very much internal. I did have this very big change of how I see the world actually. I'm not sure if this is in a lot in relation to our relationship.

Speaker: It's more of a, it's more of anything. But I used to have this very defeatist view of the world, like, oh, there's just no way things are going to change. It's just naturally like this terrible.

Speaker: So yeah, that's what I felt until, and then the pandemic hit and sort of like this is a really bad catalyst for the pandemic. But since everything kind of stopped, I was able to like stop on the hustle and bustle of what we were doing and just kind of look at like what's going on in the world. And, you know, I thought this is actually something that we built.

Speaker: This is something this, these terrible conditions is something that we made. So this is also something that we can change and rebuild. So yeah, like that really changed my whole perspective of the world and why I'm still kicking right now.

Interviewer: Yeah, but you attribute that to the experience of the pandemic, not necessarily the experiences within the relationship.

Interviewer: That's not what, yeah, that was the pandemic that catalyzed that change in you. Very interesting. As far as the relationship is concerned though, as far as being in the relationship, voila, you can't think of any other changes in you that you can attribute to being in this five-year relationship. The maturity, the security that you mentioned.

Speaker: I'd say so. I think it's connected in a sense that I'm able to talk about these things with [Partner] and like talk about, you know, these like political stuff and all that jazz. And I feel like he was kind of, I guess, not really waiting but it was something that he tried to talk to me about but it wasn't really like going into my brain. It was just going in one ear and out the other until that point.

Speaker: So it's something that we're able to talk about together now and like exchange ideas and perspectives and all. So yeah.

Interviewer: So is there anything that you feel like you can't talk about with him?

Speaker: Anything I can't talk about?

Interviewer: Yeah

Speaker: I don't think so. I guess maybe, I guess, if I start to have any doubts with where I am, I guess, and what I want to do.

Interviewer: You feel like you can't talk to him about that?

Speaker: I guess not.

Speaker: It's like sometimes I'm like when I have my little doubts, I'm not sure if I'm just having an episode or whatever or like it's just going to go away in a while but sometimes because I feel like he's involved in a sense that I start to doubt what I want for my future somehow. So I don't really want to tell him, oh, I don't know if I see him in my future. I don't know and those types of things.

Interviewer: Okay, But have you ever had those thoughts?

Speaker: Like very rarely and then like after a while I'd be like, no, that's crazy.

Interviewer: Specifically that. You mentioned that sometimes you'd have these thoughts that do I see him in my future? Tama ba intindi ko, that's what you thought. What prompts those thoughts? Is there something? Why would you think that in like a normal day? What would happen that would prompt you to think? Do I see him in my future? That you start to doubt if he has a place in your future? Does anything happen that leads you to those thoughts?

Speaker: So this is like really connected with quality time then because sometimes we talk about what we want to do and he's also like mentioned wanting to go abroad.

Interviewer: I did mention that a while ago.

Speaker: Yeah, going abroad for studies and like I don't want to stop him from that. There was actually like a time before he graduated and all that that he was like actually thinking about it and all that stuff. And I didn't tell him at all that internally I was thinking that I can't do that.

Interviewer: Oh, wow.

Speaker: It's not something I want to stop him from doing because it's what he wants to do and it's what his growth is for. And I love him so I want him to do what he thinks is like best for his growth.

Speaker: So I didn't tell him anything and I was like I'll just tell him when he actually like gets into it.

Speaker: You know, I can't do this.

Interviewer: Meaning, I can't be left here while you go away.

Interviewer: That's what you can't do. All right. And you don't think it's among the options now. Okay, we can go together but I'll find the school there or whatever. That's not an option for you.

Speaker: Yeah, because I want to stay here. So like part of that is the big things that I was talking about that we had to be on the same page. So I want to stay here and if he wants to go abroad then yeah.

Interviewer: You don't want to you don't want to stop him. But are you saying that if that happens I don't want to stop you but we're going to have to break up. Is that what you're saying?

Speaker: Yeah. Because what happens with the long-distance thing is I noticed we have we obviously both have our own lives and what happens is like most of our time most of our day is spent you know engaging with our separate lives. And then we kind of like only get to call at night or sometimes not at all just like a little chat and it's over. And you know it's it's important for me to maintain that connection and I just feel so distant when that happens.

Interviewer: Yeah. Right. So you don't think it's long-distance relationships don't work in your opinion?

Speaker: Yeah, for me.

Interviewer: Yeah. Okay. Very interesting. Yeah. So but aside from that you know something like that well obviously that's why you can't talk to him about that because it's a very important decision and it's not something you can be done with in five minutes.

Speaker: I don't want to influence his decision. Yeah.

Interviewer: But aside from from that you feel like you can talk to him about anything aside from that.

Speaker: Yeah. Yeah. Pretty much. Yeah.

Interviewer: So do I do I take it that as far as your concern there are no secrets in the relationship?

Speaker: As far as I'm concerned yeah.

Interviewer: Yeah. Yeah. Very interesting. Yeah. Okay. My next question is and I'm going to show you this actually on the scale of and I'm going to show you just the scale just for oops sorry just for demonstrate but it's clear where you see I'm going to share oh I can share a screen right and this one let's see so can you see this?

Speaker: Yes. I can see it. Yeah.

Interviewer: So that's my question like where would your answer be if I how how much this how much does this ring true for you? My partner usually really listens to me and I have a guess but I want you to say it anyway.

Speaker: Okay. Yeah. I'd say an eight.

Interviewer: An eight. Right. Very good. I would have thought somewhere in that end no said eight and why if I may ask why not nine?

Speaker: Because sometimes I mean understandably sometimes he's tired or sometimes he's just not into the conversation so he's not really like engaged with it so you know like he's not listening in that type of sense but if it's something important we make sure to like rain check it.

Interviewer: Right. So it's kind of like it's not nine because nobody is capable of nine.

Speaker: Yes

Interviewer: All right. That's clear. Yeah. What about my next question is my partner is usually responsive to my needs again you kind of touched on this earlier. Oops. Hang on. Yeah. My partner usually is responsive to my needs and you say he's very patient and where would you put him on this scale?

Speaker: I put him at a nine actually.

Interviewer: Oh wow. Okay. So this is as good as any human can get in terms of responding to your needs. Okay. Very good. Very nice. Yeah. And it's kind of clear now from your previous kwento how why you think he that's very well you said you're very lucky to have him and anybody scoring an eight and a nine. Yeah. I would then agree. Yeah. Sana all. Yeah. Very nice. All right.

Interviewer: Now onto a topic that's you touched on this earlier. Romantic intimacy, physical intimacy. This is something that some people are not very open to talking about and a lot of people think it's sensitive especially in our culture. It's very sensitive information. But if we're talking about relationship quality then a lot of people think as much as love has to be a part of it, intimacy, physical intimacy has to be. Do you agree that physical intimacy sex is an integral part of a relationship?

Speaker: This falls under the on the same page for me. Okay. So if it's something that you both want great if it's something one of you doesn't want and the other wants but maybe they're willing to compromise maybe it can work out but if and then if both of you don't want it then that's also great. So you know sort of you have to be on the same page about it but if someone if at least one of them adamantly doesn't want to do it then that's not going to work out and they're both valid.

Interviewer: Right. Very that's a very enlightened viewpoint. Very nice that your generation actually is very aware of that. That both points are valid. Very good. And you mentioned that you and [Partner] are mostly on the same page when it comes to important things and this is one of those important things and that you're on the same page on this one and may I ask what is your the both of you that you're on the same page on? What is your attitude towards this? Is it an important part of a relationship? That you have it?

Speaker: Physical touch is important for both of us actually. So yeah I think we actually got in trouble in high school because we were like you know those fluffy public displays of affection just the holding hands sleeping on resting your head on the shoulder and like things like that. So we actually got in trouble for that because they were like.

Interviewer: Oh because that's not allowed?

Speaker: Apparently.

Interviewer: That's not allowed.

Speaker: And they actually called up our parents.

Interviewer: Oh wow yeah.

Speaker: That's so I was so annoyed I was like we're not doing anything scandalous.

Interviewer: Right. Right.

Speaker: So yeah but my parents were understanding. But now beyond that beyond like let's say well since you guys are young adults you know and like actual sexual behavior whatever counts what counts as sexual behavior for you guys. What is your opinion on that? Like is that something you're both interested in doing but choose not to or is that something that you're not interested in the both of you? Actually let's say intercourse for example or beyond holding hand kissing for example. Where are you both on more intimate physical displays?

Speaker: We're very intimate with each other. There's a whole separate story for them but it will get too long.

Interviewer: You guys are sexual is what you're saying.

Speaker: Yes we are.

Interviewer: You guys are sexual and you're on the same page on that and do you think it's important?

Speaker: Well the fact that am I correct to assume that you both think that's what you both want from each other and for your relationship. Yes. And you don't think you don't want to be in a relationship with someone who doesn't want it? I think so yeah because I like to show my physical affection.

Interviewer: Right. And how in terms of satisfaction? Oh wait okay I'll just keep that. In terms of satisfaction as would you say you're satisfied as far as the sexual aspect of the of the relationship is concerned. This is as far as sex is concerned you are where you want to be. Am I right?

Speaker: Pretty much yeah. Yeah pretty much. Let's think about that a little bit more. Is there anything that can be improved or yeah let's let's let's say it that way. Is there anything that can be improved as far as sexual satisfaction is concerned in the relationship?

Speaker: I think so actually so what happened is I got birth control understandably so I got the side effects of it lowered my drive so I'm not as like I'm not as responsive to it as I used to be and that's really frustrating me and also I have irregular bleeding every day.

Interviewer: So it's more of a medical thing and it's because of the side effects yeah.

Speaker: Yeah and other than that also I think like we weren't like we don't have okay so we've been high school and then college we had like condo with roommates so we didn't really have like our own place to we didn't really have always all the time whenever we wanted to like have our own place to get intimate. So I feel like we haven't really been able to explore a lot of the things that we want to do together in terms of that aspect so we're kind of like right now stuck to just like one position and I'm getting sick of it.

Interviewer: Oh and does he know? Does he know about this?

Speaker: Yeah I've told him I've told him a few times that I wanted to try other things but we really need like a space for us you know to explore these kinds of things.

Interviewer: Oh that's interesting because you here in [city] you have roommates and then what he lives with his family right now since he's graduated he lives with his family so yeah. So no place and so that's the only limiting factor to you exploring what you want to explore it's that there's no opportunity.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Yeah very interesting yeah so that's great so you'd say yeah you're satisfied and what can be improved is not the only limiting factor is the opportunity in the circumstance which right now can't be helped. Yeah right but but as far as your own attitudes and his attitudes and no problem at all?

Speaker: Yeah we're on the same page.

Interviewer: Okay that's amazing yeah now this is the we're nearing the end I'm sorry that we we went over time a bit.

Speaker: It's alright I'm enjoying them.

Interviewer: Oh very good very nice to hear but don't worry because I just have a couple of more questions and one is this no generally again we want we want your own your own assessment no where would you say your satisfaction though how satisfied are you and again you mentioned it in many many words that you are very satisfied but where would you place it if we had to give you this scale where would you place it?

Speaker: Alright, okay so at this point in time while he's graduated living with his family and I'm still studying and condoing with a roommate and all that and we're kind of like far from each other so right now I'd say very satisfied. Okay, so I think it would probably improve if we can finally like you know cross paths officially.

Interviewer: Because where does he live now where does he live now where's his family?

Speaker: He's in [City 2] and I'm in [City 1].

Interviewer: Oh, ang layo nga. And before before he graduated he was also condoing in [City 1]?

Speaker: Yes, we were actually in the same condo so we were very spoiled.

Interviewer: So, this must be a big change this has to be a big adjustment yeah and for someone who likes quality time this has to be a big challenge?

Speaker: Pretty much yeah.

Interviewer: Yeah, do you think how does he feel about does he all do you think he misses the time as much as you do the time the the physical time together that at least you're in the same radius?

Speaker: Yeah, we talk about that you know the usual I miss you and all that and when can we see each other again?

Speaker: And then he gets stuck because I'm planning again.

Interviewer: Oh, right right right yeah because now if you want to spend time together it takes it's a whole production number.

Speaker: Yeah, extra yeah yeah.

Interviewer: And do you see this changing in the future like what is he look what's his next plan? Is he going looking for a job, or you know is he going for further studies? Do you see any any plan in the future that will bring him closer to you from [City]?

Speaker: I do so he's actually employed right now he starts work next Monday, so um yeah but he's he's based in [City 3] so it's not too far from {City} so he's gonna stick around there once I graduate I'd hope to be in the same area. Ideally we'd get to like be to get there now but I mean I understand if he wants like somewhere just in periods again.

Interviewer: Yeah yeah, [City 3] is a little closer than [City 2] right? Isn't it yeah I mean it's a little closer than [City]?

Speaker: Actually I get to travel to [City 3] right so we've actually like had a date already there we meet so that's kind of our midpoint.

Interviewer: Oh, yeah yeah okay that's that's good. Now, let's see so very very satisfied and only because am I correct to us to soon back back when he was still in [City 1] and you were living in the same building. Nasa completely satisfied ka ba dati?

Speaker: Um, well there was there is the sexual intimacy, um and the factor.

Interviewer: So that's what's holding you like?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: All right right right interesting um something with the intimacy the side effect is the birth control uh makes you experience less drive and that disappoints you, did he ever notice did he ever notice any change in your drive and has he ever verbalized that hey you're not your drive change did he ever notice that that you know?

Speaker: No, but I have told him about it so.

Interviewer: Okay okay.

Speaker: But but I he'd never told me if he noticed anything.

Interviewer: Oh, well you didn't really give him a chance because you told him yeah okay interesting interesting all right actually that's it no that's that's that's all I wanted to ask from you and uh so it's very nice to hear that this is as far as your self-report is concerned this is a high quality relationship in your opinion you have everything you could ask for almost everything you could ask for and this is about as good a relationship gets and you're very satisfied and then you do appreciate this and you're aware of what you have and aware of how special this thing that you have is and that it's going strong five years into it so.

Interviewer: Congratulations for that thank you so much yeah and the one last thing I have to ask you before we end is um are you okay. You're anonymous of course not uh you will be completely anonymous in in the data analysis but is it okay do we have your permission if to share certain portions of the transcripts like verbatim of it's not going to be traced to any identity not yours not anybody else but it's okay if we quote certain portions of the transcripts or the whole transcript like okay lang ba certain portions or kahit buo?

Speaker: Kahit buo. It's fine with me.

Interviewer: All right, thank you thank you for that uh and that's it no so again thank you so much I super appreciate you taking the time to do this and again your data will be part of a five country data

collection we're doing it for the Philippines we're doing it for the Philippines, Brazil, Turkey, France, and the USA no so you're you're with the Philippine data thank you for that and uh yeah thank you and last is um if if you can nominate a person so you're not going to nominate a person for me to interview but you're going to nominate a person for me to ask for another couple to interview and this is part of the yeah this is one of the ways that we ensure that we're getting a very diverse sample so you're not going to nominate a couple friend no you're going to nominate somebody who can lead me to a couple that you don't know you get it yeah.

Interviewer: So, if you can think about that you can just email me about it now is there anybody you think in your life who can lead me to another couple that can that I may be able to interview about.

Speaker: Should I try to keep it like out of [University] kasi I'm sure?

Interviewer: Oh yeah yeah you can you can actually that's that's good no so yeah somebody so hopefully lead me to a couple that you don't know and and you don't you don't really spend time with and actually not even acquainted with yeah yeah so if you're thinking about just email me a nominee you know that that can lead you to that couple.

Interviewer: Yay okay thank you so much anything else do you have any questions for me?

Speaker: Um none. I hope you uh when you see [Partner] next week?

Interviewer: Okay yeah yeah.

Speaker: I hope that you also get like some good insights from him.

Interviewer: I'm sure I will yeah I'm sure I will.

Speaker: Thank you.

Interviewer: So and it was a pleasure yeah it was a good chat actually no thank you thank you yeah so yun lang yun lang and thank you very much um I wait for your email if you ever think of a person who can nominate another couple huh all right thank you [Speaker] thank you for the time all right thank you very much.

Speaker: Have a good evening.

Interviewer: Have a good evening have a good weekend as well no with the rain thank you, are you are you are you [redacted]?

Speaker: I understand [Language] but I don't speak it.

Interviewer: Oh, but you grew up there?

Speaker: I grew up here.

Interviewer: Yes yes, interesting oh yeah have a great weekend.

Speaker: Thank you thank you so much bye.

Interviewer: Bye and email me lang, yes okay thank you.